

DAD · JAPAN PACKING LIST

01 BAGS

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- ☐ **Main checked case** — max 23 kg; height + width + depth under 158 cm in total to take on trains. Leave space to bring things back home.
- ☐ **Soft carry-on bag** — under 5 kg on the flight out; it is also your weekend bag for Arashiyama & Ine, 23–27 Sep, when the big cases stay in Kyoto.
- ☐ **Day bag** — any smaller bag you are happy carrying for days out — holds water, food, layers/ rain jacket, and whatever you buy.
- ☐ **Packable tote** — extra just in case shops charge for bags and there are no bins on the streets.

02 CLOTHES

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WEATHER Kyoto 24–30°C and humid · Tokyo 22–26°C · Kiso mornings 12–16°C

LAUNDRY 19–22 Sep · 27 Sep · 1–4 Oct

CITY WANDERING

HEAT + AIR CON

TEMPLES

LOCAL RESTAURANTS

SHOPPING

NIGHTS OUT

TRAIL DAY

TRAVEL DAYS

- ☐ **3 lightweight shirts** — one smarter
- ☐ **3–4 T-shirts / polos**
- ☐ **2 lightweight everyday trousers**
- ☐ **1 smarter trousers**
- ☐ **1 shorts**
- ☐ **1 hiking outfit**
- ☐ **1 jumper or fleece**
- ☐ **1 packable waterproof rain jacket**
- ☐ **7–8 underwear · 7–8 socks + walking socks** — shoes come off constantly, so socks are always on show
- ☐ **Lightweight sleepwear**
- ☐ **Swimwear**
- ☐ **Cap / sun hat**
- ☐ **Main daily walking trainers** — broken in, grippy enough for the trail. Should be easy to take on and off.
- ☐ **Second pair of back up shoes** — in case other pairs rub, break, get dirty, get wet. Should be easy to take on and off. Maybe smarter for nights out.
- ☐ **Slip-ons / Sandals** — for if you need a break from trainers, if it's really hot, or if you get fed up of taking trainers on and off every time you enter a building.
- ☐ **2–3 favourite outfits** — Japan is known for its jazzy fashion!

03 TOILETRIES

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- ☐ **Toothbrush, toothpaste, razor, moisturiser** — the usual
- ☐ **Deodorant** — bring your own — Japanese ones are mild
- ☐ **Earplugs + eye mask** — the farmhouse room on 28 Sep is shared
- ☐ **Sunscreen**
- ☐ **Insect repellent** — river valleys in September
- ☐ **Small hand towel + pocket tissues** — public loos often provide neither
- ☐ **Lightweight quick-dry towel** — hotels and inns provide; the farmhouse hostel and the self-catering house may not

04 HAND LUGGAGE

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Tip: pack one day's outfit in hand luggage in case of luggage delays.

- ☐ **Regular medication** — 18 days + a few spare, original packaging, prescription copy — in the cabin bag
- ☐ **Glasses - reading glasses + Sunglasses**
- ☐ **Phone + charging cable**
- ☐ **Type-A plug adaptor** — US-style two flat pins; Japan is 100 V
- ☐ **Power bank** — cabin bag only — not allowed in the hold
- ☐ **Headphones**
- ☐ **Passport** — plus a photo of it on your phone
- ☐ **Two payment cards, kept separately**
- ☐ **Yen cash**
- ☐ **Coin purse** — Japan runs on coins
- ☐ **A pen** — forms on the plane
- ☐ **Reusable water bottle**
- ☐ **Compact umbrella** **OPTIONAL**
- ☐ **Handheld fan** **OPTIONAL**
- ☐ **UK driving licence + 1949 International Driving Permit** **OPTIONAL** — only if we do the go-karts
- ☐ **Travel pillow** **OPTIONAL** — we will spend lots of time travelling on planes and trains.
- ☐ **Compression socks** **OPTIONAL** — long haul flight.

01

PERSONAL ADMIN

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- ☐ **Passport valid for the trip, with a blank page**
- ☐ **Send Mica a photo of the passport photo page** — she needs it for the Visit Japan Web entry forms
- ☐ **Know your bank card PINs; bring a second card**
- ☐ **Cash: ¥20,000–30,000 to land with** — order it this week, or draw it at the 7-Eleven ATM at the airport
- ☐ **Arrange travel insurance and save details.**
- ☐ **1949 International Driving Permit** — £5.50 from a PayPoint shop, done on the spot; cannot be obtained in Japan. If we decide to do MarioKart in Tokyo,
- ☐ **UK driving licence** — for the above.
- ☐ **Check any medication you take is allowed in Japan** — products with codeine or pseudoephedrine are restricted
- ☐ **Ensure you have enough medication for 18 days + spare, original packaging, prescription copy**
- ☐ **Download films and shows for the flights** — onto the iPad or phone before leaving — nothing streams in the air. Two pairs of AirPods can share one iPad (Share Audio); other headphones need a splitter
- ☐ **Clear enough phone storage for photos**
- ☐ **Charge phone and power bank the night before**

02

PHONE

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- ☐ **Data for Japan** — eSIM (install before leaving, switch on in Japan), or check your roaming plan
- ☐ **Google Maps** — offline areas — Kyoto · Osaka · Amanohashidate/Ine · Kiso Valley · Tokyo
- ☐ **Google Translate** — download Japanese — try the camera on any Japanese label at home
- ☐ **Lampkeys on Tour website** — Safari → Share → Add to Home Screen; open every page once on Wi-Fi; test in airplane mode
- ☐ **GO taxi app** OPTIONAL — useful late at night
- ☐ **Suica in Apple Wallet**
 - WHAT IT IS** Japan's travel card, like an Oyster card — but it lives on your phone
 - SET IT UP** Wallet app → tap + (top right) → Transit Card → scroll to Japan, choose Suica → pick about ¥3,000 → pay with Apple Pay. Works straight away; no need to unlock the phone to use it
 - USE IT** hold the top of the phone on the reader at the ticket gate going in, and again coming out — the fare comes off automatically. Also pays in convenience stores and vending machines: say "Suica" and tap
 - TOP UP** open the card in Wallet → Add Money
 - IF IT WON'T ADD** no problem — we buy a physical card at the airport

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